



Physics Definition By Vasumitra Gajbhiye

- **Impulse.**
force x change in time (for which it acts)
- **Velocity.**
speed in a given direction
- **Momentum.**
mass x velocity
- **Electrical current.**
charge passing a point per unit time.
- **Spring constant.**
force per unit extension
- **Speed.**
distance travelled per unit time
- **Moment of a force.**
force x perpendicular distance from pivot/ point
- **Work done.**
Force x distance moved in the direction of the force
- **Refractive index.**
The ratio of the speeds of a wave in two different regions.
- **Ultrasound.**
Sound with frequency higher than 20kHz.
- **Density.**
mass per unit volume.
- **Pressure.**
force per unit area
- **Gravitational field strength.**
force per unit mass
- **Resultant force.**
change in momentum per unit time.

- **Potential difference.**

Work done by a unit charge passing through a component.

- **Power.**

Work done per unit time i.e. energy transferred per unit time.

- **Acceleration.**

rate of change of velocity OR change in speed per unit time/s

- **Half-life.**

The time taken for half the nuclei of an isotope sample to decay.

- **Principal axis.**

the line passing through the centre of a lens perpendicular to its surface.

- **Specific latent heat of fusion.**

(thermal) energy to melt per kg of solid (to change state from solid to liquid)

- **Normal.**

the line drawn at right angles to a surface at the point where a ray hits the surface.

- **Hubble constant H_0 .**

Ratio of the speed at which the galaxy is moving away from the earth to its distance from the earth.

- **Principal focus.**

the point at which rays of light parallel to the axis converge after passing through a converging lens.

- **Angle of reflection.**

the angle between the reflected ray and the normal drawn at the point where the ray hits the surface.

- **Angle of incidence.**

the angle between the incident ray and the normal drawn at the point where the ray hits the surface.

- **Specific heat capacity.**

energy required to raise the temperature of 1kg/ 1g/ unit mass of a substance by 1°C/ unit temperature

- **Angle of refraction.**

the angle between a refracted ray and the normal to the surface at the point where it passes from one medium to another.

- **Electromotive force.**

It is the chemical energy transferred to electrical energy. This energy is supplied by the source/batter/cell in driving a unit charge around a complete circuit.

- **Limit of proportionality.**

- up to the limit of proportionality a spring follows Hooke's law i.e. extension is proportional to load.
- Beyond it spring deforms and doesn't follow Hooke's law.